

ANITA RAMPAL 55 PROFESSOR, Department of Education, University of Delhi

HER LIFE'S WORK

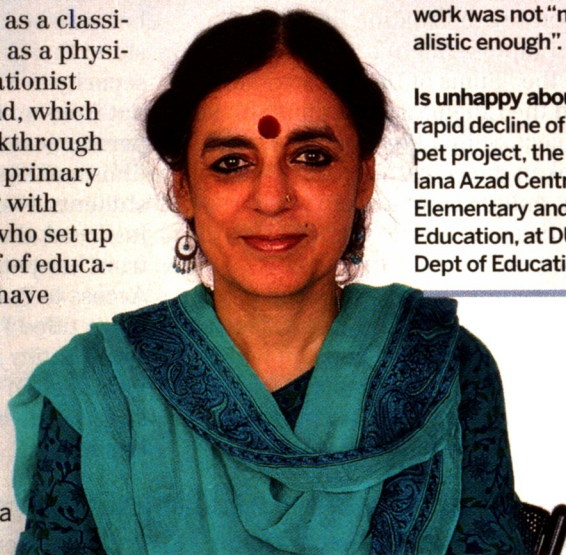
If primary school children who study maths and EVS now find their books a lot more fun, much of the credit goes to Anita Rampal, a rare physicist who switched tracks to becoming an educator. At NCERT, on deputation from Delhi University's Central Institute of Education, she spent as much time headhunting school teachers as well as artists who could breathe freshness into texts. Having cut her teeth on the avant garde work at the Hoshangabad Science Teaching Programme in Madhya Pradesh, she has spent a lifetime at the cusp of the people's science movement initiated by Eklavya and Kerala Sahitya Parishad. As a Nehru fel-

low, she spent 15 years at the Nehru Memorial Museum and Library under the nurturing leadership of Ravindra Kumar, studying the pedagogy of science and education. Her training as a classical and modern dancer, as a physicist and a science educationist make her a unique blend, which was evident in the breakthrough she managed in NCERT's primary school textbooks. Along with husband Vinod Raina, who set up Eklavya, she is one-half of education's first couple, who have swapped having their own children for raising an entire generation. *by Kaveree Bamzai*

Education B.Sc, M.Sc, Ph.D Delhi University.

Is never afraid of An honest battle, as when the NDA government terminated her UGC fellowship because her work was not "nationalistic enough".

Is unhappy about The rapid decline of her pet project, the Maulana Azad Centre for Elementary and Social Education, at DU's Dept of Education.



We have had differences of opinion, but it's always a pleasure to differ with her." C.N. Subramaniam, Director, Eklavya

ARVIND GUPTA 56 VISITING SCIENTIST, Children's Centre, Inter-University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics, Pune

THE GREAT GAME

MANDAR DEODHAR



Call him a teacher and he shrugs. Say he's a toymaker and he's happy. The science enthusiast wants to eliminate the passive-observant methods of teaching science. To make students 'understand' rather than 'learn', he employs an unconventional method of teaching science through toy-making, using material that most people would treat as junk. So, a straw is made into a multi-tone flute to teach the students about air pressure, a dried sketch-pen is transformed into a musical oboe, while an empty camera film can and a torn balloon are used to demonstrate the working of the diaphragm. His aim is to ensure that science no longer remains a feared, 'high-scorers' subject that can be only explained in a formal laboratory environment. Having worked with over 2,000 schools in about 20 countries, Gupta has set up a unique children's centre at the Inter-University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics in Pune, where he holds workshops for students from 100 schools across the city. *by Pankti Mehta*

Education B.Tech from IIT Kanpur.

Usually to be found Creating new educational toys as also digitising and translating books for his online library, which has 2,000 books on science.

Most recent work *Science Skills and Thrills*, 2008, that takes science out of the classroom into life.

"The work he is doing in science is innovative, exciting, and joyful. It removes the fear of science among students."

Arun Kapur, Director, Vasant Valley School, Delhi